



Xulc Expansion

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Kill it with Fire!



As the light within the beast's un-soul goes out, the other therans cease their decrepit assault. Out of the shattered corpse of the dying thing before you crawls a foul creature. An ophidian mass of arms unfurls in a silvery grey heap, emitting a moist hiss as if releasing pressure. A long tongue hangs limp from the centre of its twisting astral shape, dripping the crimson meat of its dying host. Barbed hooks bristle down its otherwise featureless limbs in a clicking shudder, signalling something most foul in the bodies of the other infected creatures. The crystalline carapace of urns break apart and flower, revealing a writhing mass of similarly hooked limbs. The chewed bodies of the stomaw take on a wholly different kind of asymmetry as they begin to writhe in a frenzy both ecstatic and alien. Ether itself appears to bend around and recoil the infected monstrosities, as they attack with fresh vigor.

Special Rules



Flip the adversary book to page 3. Stomaws are now writhing stomaws and urns are now stolen urns. Ability tokens stay on the same ability block after flipping pages.

Writhing stomaw and stolen urn have the **infected** trait.

Spawn one cleaving xulc in the space of the urn or stomaw that was just slain. If the urn was slain, read 2, "Riddled Shell", 2 now.

Infected



Make sure you have the Xulc board – flipped to the A side – xulc standees, and xulc dice nearby.

When an **Infected** adversary is slain, roll the xulc dice and spawn the result in the space of the slain adversary. A result of spawns one cleaving xulc, spawns one armor xulc, or spawns one flying xulc. The last face of the dice has no icon. A blank result slays the xulc within the host and no xulc is spawned. If all standees of a xulc type are on the map and the result of rolling the xulc dice is that xulc type, nothing is spawned.

For the remainder of this campaign, keep the xulc board, xulc standees, and xulc dice nearby. All



enemies with the **Infected** trait follow these rules. Until instructed otherwise, always use the A side of the xulc board.

Xulc are adversaries and they take their turns before all other adversaries, activating in the order they are printed on the xulc board from top to bottom, then in standee order.

Codex Links



Each time a stolen urn is slain, read "Riddled Shell", 2.



At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, read "Infected", 2.

Riddled Shell



As the infected urn perishes, intricate mutations on its shell become clear. Concentric rings of keratin form in strange but beautiful spheres around shards of dead parasite. The hard stone is the urn's natural response to the infection in overdrive, but it possesses a strange quality that is able to absorb the ether from nearby crystals. This will probably come in useful.

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that slayed the stolen urn gains one "Dimming Stone" item (found in the Xulc merchant deck). They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Infected



Conclusion

With the last of the infected monstrosities destroyed, a haunting din falls over the rovers - the realization that Silky hasn't said a word. The elder zusag merely stands in awe and abject horror of the scene before him, the gentle twitch of his ears the only sign of life he displays. "My ancestors protect me". Silky's contemplative appeal to the long-dead is broken by a tremor across the

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Q 3

surface of the stagnant waters surrounding you. With a horrifying screech, several of these freshly hatched parasites launch themselves out of the water at each of you. You're able to bat many of them away by magic or blade, but they keep coming until each of you rovers, heroes all, are lost under a pile of bulbous, undulating nightmares. After a moment that feels like eternity, brilliant light sears through to your vision as Silky stands there, held aloft by ancient glyphs burning through the horrors until they shrivel and burn. Silky collapses to the floor in a heap, etheric energy leaving glittering plumes of smoke from his exhausted form.

As you rush to his aid, you all notice a throbbing pain. Amidst the many cuts you earned from the mountain of creatures, one pulsates with malign power. A single stem of the parasite digs deep, a kind of proboscis broken clean at the tip. Blue-black malaise attempts to spread as your wound immediately begins to necrotize, but you feel the magic and strong connection to ether you have harnessed over your many adventures holding it back. Looking at each other with concern, the pain turns to power at the source of the pain. This power spreads out across your body in a comforting but unfamiliar warmth and you intuit something far more frightening than the idea of immediate necrosis. The parasite is trying to appeal to you. It even tells you its name.

"Xulc."

Victory!



Reward

You have been infected! Your magic is strong and holding the parasite at bay... for now.

The parasite is attempting to strengthen its bond with you. As a result of this, all Rovers gain +3 [HP].

Open the infected deck of skill cards. All Rovers must select and permanently add one infected skill card to their hand. This infected card does not count toward the number of skill or reaction cards you may take into an encounter.

Campaign Link



Intermission - "Strange Days",  6

What was Lost

Q 4

A bundle of dead urns lie in a heap. It doesn't appear that they had been infected by the xulc, rather they had been... dismantled. Carved apart, left for dead. Studied.

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

What Once Was

Q 5

A small starling shard lies, utterly alien in this stomaw nest. It appears untouched, but how did it get here? What was it doing? Could the nest-creature have brought it here before abandoning it?

Reward



The Rover that looted the hoard tile gains one "**Starling Shard**" item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

What Will Never Be

Q 6

Here lies the body of a zusag querist. Long dead, she appears as if mid-autopsy, torn open and rearranged curiously. Though there is nothing that can be done for the poor thing now, a small pair of gems lie glowing in her hand.

Reward



The Rover that looted the hoard tile gains one "**Gemini Stellate**" item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Conclusion

Slaying the monstrous creature is a frenetic task. Though it appears clumsy, it wields its simple hammer with brutal speed and ferocity, more egg sacs spawning, bloating and bursting various xulc parasites in moments as it does. Despite its multiple blows, it shows no sign of weakness or wound. It doesn't slow, it doesn't appear fatigued. It is alive and murderous, until it isn't. One final blow brings it to its knees, and a bubbling, rising tension within its tumorous body swells. Inflating rapidly as though containing a thousand tiny detonations, the **nidus** explodes in a plume of vile multichromatic gas, limp, empty legs draping the ground like a drained boil. The gas brings you and your zusag companions to tears, and you do what you can to ignore the fact that your xulc **loves** it.

The wounded Ozendyn and his coruscopod limp over from the shelter they were taking since you joined the fight. "I'm starting to think these zusag haven't been the only thing keeping tabs on me, Rovers. Though at least you're more useful in a fight". The warrior throws a jab at his zusag companions expecting an equal retort, but is greeted with silence as they stand silently around the body of one of their fallen. "Poor thing."

Ozendyn continues. "She didn't even know what was coming. Had no chance to defend herself. This is my fault." The Sentinel's tone sobers, as Gargaki stops consuming the corpse of an infected stomaw to comfort him. "They've been following me since we felled Bazhar. I finally let them join me, thought I'd give them a chance. Truth be told, it felt good to have a clan again. We went about clearing up remnant stomaw nests until one of ours went missing. That's how we came across this foul place. A sickness thrives here, and this thing - this **beautiful** monster was some kind of midwife to the infection. It was.. studying her. Most foul, Rovers. Most foul."

"It's not your fault, Ozendyn." One of the zusag pipes up with a wisdom belying her age.

"This is what a querist is, and a balatronist even more so. Adventure is a risk, and a risk isn't real if it doesn't have real consequences. Lurpen would have known that as we all do. At least we have stopped the spread of this bothersome blight, Lurpen gave her life to a worthy cause." Ozendyn nods thoughtfully at the zusag's words. A potent reminder that as mischievous as these querists appear, they are still disciples of a zusag

school. His solemnity breaks as he turns back to you. "What's wrong with your skin, Rovers?"

Looking at your bodies, deep purple veins stretch a sickly web beneath your skin. You can feel the infection worsening, as if inhaling the gas of the nidus has - **laughed** **me something its let me in I can feel you know I can** - worsened your condition. Your body twists in shape. You can feel yourself changing. You must finish the tasks Silky assigned to you before returning to him. At least then it's one less thing to admonish you for after he realizes you failed to tell him about your infection.

Victory!



You've slain a powerful foe and learned much about this new threat, but your foe has also learned a lot about you and your infection worsens.

All Rovers must select and permanently add one infected skill card to their hand. This infected card DOES count toward the number of skill or reaction cards you may take in an encounter.

Rovers gain 20*R .

On your Xulc campaign sheet mark the milestone "**Slayed the Nidus**".

Campaign Link



Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" or "**Made a Powerful Ally**" marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 3 - "**Keen Debtors**",  16
or Encounter 4 - "**Ought Never to Sprout**",  20.

If you have the milestones "**Made A Powerful Ally**" marked and "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 3 - "**Keen Debtors**",  18.

If you have the milestones "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" marked and "**Made A Powerful Ally**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 4 - "**Ought Never to Sprout**",  24.

Conclusion

Attempting to kill this lipidoid monolith is like trying to carve one's way through a living mountain. The body at the zenith, grotesquely disproportionate compared to the lower slag heap, wields a simple hammer with brutal speed and ferocity. Such a base and primal manner of dealing wounds from such a nightmarish cluster of eggs and death. Every chunk carved off of the creature bloats and bursts it apart, various xulc parasites skittering and flailing out of every wound. You hack, you tear, you pierce, and you enchant until the flesh mound shrinks, disassembled, de-bodied, de-limbed, de-faced, de-destroyed. Fetid gore rains through the air from the brutality you and your allies exact until it causes total system collapse. Inflating rapidly as though containing a thousand tiny detonations, the **nidus** explodes in a plume of vile multichromatic gas, flaps of skin and meat floating the ground like pieces of wet tarp. The gas brings you and your companions to tears, and you do what you can to ignore the fact that your xulc **loves it**.

The wounded Ozendyn and his coruscopod limp over from the shelter they were taking since you joined the fight. "I'm starting to think these zusag haven't been the only thing keeping tabs on me, Rovers. Though at least you're more useful in a fight". The warrior throws a jab at his zusag companions expecting an equal retort, but is greeted with silence as they stand silently around the bodies of their fallen. "Poor things." Ozendyn continues. "This is my fault." The Sentinel's tone sobers, as Gargaki stops consuming the corpse of an infected stomaw to comfort him. "They've been following me since we felled Bazhar. I finally let them join me, I'd give them a chance. Truth be told, it felt good to have a clan again. We went about clearing up remnant stomaw nests until one of ours went missing. That's how we came across this foul place. A sickness thrives here, Rovers. Unlike any I've seen. This thing - this - **beautiful resplendent** - monster was some living incubator for the infection. It wasn't like this when we got here, it looked more like a..."

"Like a man," Makaal interrupts?

"Yes," Ozendyn continues.

"Exactly," Makaal pipes up, "we've seen things like this, back out towards the Thunder Mesa. Infected blessed humans, but nothing on this scale."



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Hra shudders, vines and leaves shaking from their body to the ground.

"This sickness has spread that far already," the shock in Ozendyn's voice is like a ringing bell? "How have none of us heard of this until now?"

"It appears this contagion has spread fast," Mo offers, "or has laid dormant for a while, only to make itself known now," Ozendyn finishes.

He turns to you. "What's wrong with your skin, Rovers?"

Looking at your bodies, deep purple veins stretch a sickly web beneath your skin. You can feel the infection worsening, as if inhaling the gas of the nidus cluster has **taught me something it's let me in I can feel you know I can** - worsened your condition. Your body twists in shape. You can feel yourself changing. Mo and Hra both let the ether within them swell. The starling crafter speaks with an unusual certainty: "We must return to Silky now, Rovers. We can delay no longer."

Victory!



You've slain a powerful foe and learned much about this new threat, but your foe has also learned a lot about you and your infection worsens.

All Rovers must select and permanently add one infected skill card to their hand. This infected card DOES count toward the number of skill or reaction cards you may take into an encounter.

Rovers gain 20*R

On your Xulc campaign sheet, mark the milestone "**Slayed the Nidus**".

Campaign Link



Encounter 5 - "**Knowable Only by Analogy**",

28

What Do We Have Here?

9

The ground is littered with various broken carriages, baskets of resources and glowing crystals that the ranger party had harvested prior to their ambush. Mo and Makaal gathered what they could, but they missed a bit. Even in the midst of such carnage, you invoke the old Rover maxim that has kept generations of your ilk thriving across Lalos; “Finder’s Keepers”.

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

To determine what is found, roll an ether dice from the general pool and gain the item corresponding to the result:



- One “Flaming Coalyst” item



- One “Weltering Coalyst” item



- One “Encrusting Coalyst” item



- One “Aviating Coalyst” item



- One “Condensed Will” item



- One “Scour Ichor” item

The Rover that looted the hoard tile may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

We’re Leaving

10

Conclusion

Dispatching the last infected creature, you take a breath.

“You rack up a mean tally, Rovers. It’s going to be hard to pay you back.” Makaal almost seems to throw the words at you, but they land more like a ball tossed than a knife.

His playfulness, as persistent as it might be, doesn’t last as long as he’d like.

“These things... What are they, Rovers?” Mo asks, tendrils dripping in some vague gesture towards sweat. “They are devoid utterly of ether... life without life.” Yet are we not alive? You do your best to explain, though said explanation involves a lot of shrugging. The merchant and the crafter alike express distress at the news that Silky got hurt, but it soon shifts to a new fear.



10

“These parasites. They made it this far from the Unsouled Barrens already? Or maybe they were already here?” Makaal asks.

“Or maybe they just arrived. Like I, and all other starlings do.” Mo responds, blankly.

At this point, the specifics feel irrelevant. It is simply known that the **Xulc** are here, in many places, and they are ravaging and spreading like wildfire.

The next part doesn’t need to be said. Mo, Makaal, and Grandpaw all move towards you. “Yes, Rovers”, Mo begins. “We’ll accompany you once more, at least until the scope of this threat is understood.”

“And besides,” Makaal continues, “who’s gonna keep you all on your feet? For a reasonable price, of course.”

Mo leans down and wraps one their ‘hands’ around the shell of an armored xulc. Assessing it with their many sensory tendrils, they turn and address the Rovers specifically. “I would like to experiment with these creatures in my workshop also, with your permission, Rovers. Their bodies display unusual properties. Even in my hand now I feel the xulc-parts rejecting the ether of my form. There may be valuable tools to be made from these.”

“Or just the ugliest scarves you’ve ever seen,” Makaal adds.

“That too.” finishes Mo. Grandpaw lets out an affirmative bark.

Victory!



You’ve rescued Mo, Makaal, and Grandpaw. They are again indebted to you.

Rovers gain 20*R .

Mo and Makaal’s shop is open again. Their shop is in the same state as it was at the end of the core box campaign. Their shop consists of the merchant level 1 through 4 decks. Check your core box campaign sheet and add all reward weapons and armors marked to the shop.

On your Xulc campaign sheet, mark the milestone “Rescued the Merchants... Again”.



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Campaign Link

Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone “**Slayed the Nidus**” or “**Made a Powerful Ally**” marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 2 - “**Nidifugous by Nature**”,  8 or
Encounter 4 - “**Ought Never to Sprout**”,  20.

If you have the milestones “**Made a Powerful Ally**” marked and “**Slayed the Nidus**” not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 2 - “**Nidifugous by Nature**”,  12.

If you have the milestones “**Slayed the Nidus**” marked and “**Made a Powerful Ally**” not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 4 - “**Ought Never to Sprout**”,  24.

The Road Yawns

Conclusion

Dispatching the last infected creature, you take a breath.

“You rack up a mean tally, Rovers. It’s going to be hard to pay you back.” Makaal almost seems to throw the words at you, but they land more like a ball tossed than a knife.

His playfulness, as persistent as it might be, doesn’t last as long as he’d like as he winces at Mo tightening the sling around his shoulder. Grandpaw lets out a pained wheeze as he licks his wounds. He looks at you with uncertainty.

“These things... What are they, Rovers?” Mo asks, tendrils limp and lifeless. “They are devoid utterly of ether... life without life.” **Yet are we not alive?** You do your best to explain, though said explanation involves a lot of shrugging.

“Is that what is wrong with your skin?” Makaal asks. “It almost looks like the same thing that happened to these poor creatures. Are you infected too? Are you going to turn into one of these?” **Soon.**

An uncertain silence is all you have to offer. Thankfully, it’s enough. The merchant and crafter look at each other with a deep fear, until Mo winces and loses their balance. Hra shifts their weight and catches Mo in their tendrils. The two starlings glow gently for a moment, a process that appears to alleviate Mo’s pain.

At this point, the specifics feel irrelevant. It is

simply known that the **Xulc** are here, in many places, and they are ravaging and spreading like wildfire.

“Take us with you.” Makaal asks in the most assertive voice his young, broken body can muster. “You... I mean we all shouldn’t be alone right now.”

Mo leans down and wraps one their ‘hands’ around the shell of an armored xulc. Assessing it with their many sensory tendrils, they turn and address the Rovers specifically. “I would like to experiment with these creatures in my workshop also. We need to know how they work. Their bodies display unusual properties. Even in my hand now I feel the xulc-parts rejecting the ether of my form. We may be able to make weapons out of these.”

“Or just the ugliest scarves you’ve ever seen,” Makaal adds.

“That too,” finishes Mo. Grandpaw lets out an affirmative bark.

Victory!



You’ve rescued Mo, Makaal, and Grandpaw. They are again indebted to you.

Rovers gain 20*R .

Mo and Makaal’s shop is open again. Their shop is in the same state as it was at the end of the core box campaign. Their shop consists of the merchant level 1 through 4 decks. Check your core box campaign sheet and add all reward weapons and reward armors marked to the shop.

On your Xulc campaign sheet, mark the milestone “**Rescued the Merchants... Again**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 5 - “**Knowable Only by Analogy**”,  28

Conclusion

You help Hra break through the infected silvans to the object of their focus - a single starling crystal, half embedded in a treestump shrine. The starling plucks it free with a tendril, brings it close to their face, and lets out a sound that feels like the grief of the earth. Around you, even despite the shattered xulc bodies, flowers blossom at the sound.

Hra turns to you, the first time they have done so. You've just fought side-by-side, an experience that inevitably creates a unique kind of bond, but to have the hulking starling appraise you directly with their resplendent violet 'eyes' yields only a feeling of humility.

"I see it now," Hra rumbles. "My purpose."

"Come, Rovers. Rove. We have parasites to extinguish." You move to tell Hra that the journey ahead may be difficult and long, but the starling simply extends a tendril to each of you, a small blue flower in each. There are most certainly worse ways to make companions.

Victory!



You've saved Hra from the Xulc.

Rovers gain 20*R

For the remainder of the campaign, Hra is a character ally to Rovers, and starts each encounter deployed with you. For now, only use Hra's "**Marl**" side.

On your Xulc campaign sheet, mark the milestone "**Made a Powerful Ally**".

Campaign Link



Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone "**Slayed the Nidus**" or "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 2 - "**Nidifugous by Nature**", 8 or
Encounter 3 - "**Keen Debtors**", 16.

If you have the milestones "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" marked and "**Slayed the Nidus**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 2 - "**Nidifugous by Nature**", 12.



If you have the milestones "**Slayed the Nidus**" marked and "**Rescued the Merchants... Again**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 3 - "**Keen Debtors**", 18.

Purpose

Conclusion

You help Hra break through the infected silvans to the object of their focus - a single starling crystal, half embedded in a treestump shrine. The starling plucks it free with a tendril, brings it close to their face, and lets out a sound that feels like the grief of the earth. Around you, even despite the shattered xulc bodies, flowers blossom at the sound.

Hra turns to you, the first time they have done so. The starling, despite the obvious chunks carved out of its form, still stands with a defiant power. "Appreciation, Rovers."

The amethyst glow where the starlings 'eyes' would be narrow on you. "No. The parasites are in you too. But subdued." **Wailing**. "Weak." No. "Unable to take you fully."

Until you let us in. Mo and Makaal look at each other with a mixture of relief and concern. "I hate being so right all the time," Makaal utters under his breath.

Hra moves closer, head first towards you. They are almost intimidatingly close now. You brace for another combat, until they bring their head tall again.

"I see it now," Hra rumbles. "My purpose."

"Come, Rovers. Rove." **Disgusting**. "We have parasites to extinguish." **Why would you want this abomination with you?** "And Rovers to heal." **It won't work.** Tired, wounded and frankly afraid, you don't argue with the starling as it starts to lumber towards the far village of Tuor.

Victory!



You've saved Hra from the Xulc.

Rovers gain 20*R

For the remainder of the campaign, Hra is a character ally to Rovers, and starts each encounter with them. For now, only use Hra's "**Marl**" side.

On your Xulc campaign sheet, mark the milestone "**Made a Powerful Ally**".

Campaign Link

Encounter 5 - "Knowable Only by Analogy",  28

Not One, But Two

This nightmare feels impossible to bring down, a body piloted by an entire colony of parasites, but you hack at its flesh regardless. Hacking and cutting, sending projectiles of steel and ether, the flesh around the base of its neck begins to tear. With one powerful blow, you rend the head from its body, taking the wings at its shoulders with it.

The smell is putrid, but the headless body doesn't fall to the ground. Instead, the star-like arms of the xulc inside flail from the wound, hooking into each other, grafting themselves into a terrible flower of grey meat. Hundreds of little xulc limbs scrabble out from the base of the severed head, twitching the vibrant wings into some senseless motion in the air. You have a distinct, vile notion that you have not killed one creature here, but created two.

Special Rules

Hastadilling

The xulc colony within the Hastadilling are ripping it apart.

Spawn the Head using a normal one hex base within ↗ 1 of the Hastadilling. The Hastadilling now uses the Hastadilling Headless statistic block, recovering its current ♥ to maximum. Move the Hastadilling ability token to the same ability number on the Hastadilling Headless.

Head

The Head uses the unique logic keyword, drag. When the Head moves with the drag logic keyword, all enemies within ↗ 1 of it must move in such a way as to stay adjacent to the Head, moving the fewest spaces to do so.

Codex Links

 15 Immediately after the action where the Hastadilling Headless is defeated, read "Separate But Whole",  9.

 16 Immediately after the action where the Head is slain, read "Crush",  9.

Separate But Whole

Now fending off the decapitated bulk of the hastadilling, your blows cripple the giant body faster than the xulc inside can graft-heal it. It responds to this pressure by doing something you wouldn't have expected; it sheds the most broken of the hastadilling's limbs entirely. Xulc flesh melds and flows into pseudo limbs to replace them—the xulc isn't just possessing the remains of this poor creature now, it's supplanting it. **Improving it.**

Special Rules

Hastadilling Headless

The xulc colony is becoming desperate.

Spawn the Undercarriage using a normal one hex base within ↗ 1 of the Hastadilling Headless. The Hastadilling Headless now uses the Hastadilling Core statistic block, recovering its current ♥ to maximum. Move the Hastadilling Headless ability token to the same ability number on the Hastadilling Core.

Codex Links

 17 Immediately after the action where the Undercarriage is slain, read "Rip and Tear",  10.

 18 At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, read "Until It Is Done",  10.

Crush

Unwilling to create yet another creature to fight, when you destroy the hastadilling's head, you ensure to smash it until no discernable shape can be seen. As if the remains of the infested host heard your thoughts **we did**, the parasites themselves erupt from the pulverised skull to attack you.

Special Rules

Spawn R Flying Xulc within ↗ 0-1 of where the Head was slain.

Rip and Tear

17

With the grafted meat of the hastadilling's body destroyed, all that is left is to slay the xulc colony that was within it.

Special Rules



Spawn R Cleaving Xulc within 0-1 of where the Undercarriage was slain.

Until It is Done

18

Conclusion

"I, uh... I think it's dead. You can probably stop now."

There is no small hint of fear in Makaal's voice as he shouts over to you, but you each throw one last blow into the wet hastadilling paste to be sure. Killing this thing did not require strength or brute force - but technique. It was not murder, it was surgery. Forceful, terrified surgery.

This was unlike anything you'd seen before. **Wasn't it wonderful?** No. It wasn't. You aren't sure if you said that aloud or not, and you don't wish to look up to the faces of the other non-infected to check. It was vile. An entire colony of xulc using a poor creature like it was base material to reshape and reform to their desire. Your head still rings from that thing's scream. **We are not just cohabiters. Rovers.** You shiver as it cockily calls you by your title, like it's showing you how fast it's learning. **We are evolution. We are perfection. We are - "Silence!"**

You're absolutely certain you said this aloud. You all did. **Let us show you.**

The xulc show you.

Skin breaks. Hair and fur mats and grows sticky. Limbs and wings and organs that don't belong to you begin to mutate out of your body. Theran parts, entoman parts, silvan parts. It would feel like a hallucination if it didn't feel so real. It doesn't hurt, it's just sensitive, like new skin under a blister. Hra moves to protect Mo and Makaal, who are screaming. You can't make out their screams beneath your own. For the first time, the grey xulc flesh is visible atop, between, intermingled with your own.

This is how good it feels. We will shape ourselves together. To newer, more powerful things. You just have to submit. We're so close now.

A smash of glass. Blackout.

Victory!



Your infection worsens!

All Rovers must replace one of their class traits with one infected trait. Write in your campaign log which trait was replaced.

Rovers gain 20*R and one "Gestalt Snare" item (found in the Xulc merchant deck).

Campaign Link



Intermission - "Loathsome Changes None Could Explain", 30.

I Hope This Was Worth It

19

Conclusion

Packing the last of the living xulc samples into the basket on Grandpaw's back, the arkenyn growls in protest. "It's okay big fella" says Makaal as he runs his fingers through Grandpaw's fur. "They won't hurt you."

Later, at camp, Mo and Makaal are tinkering by the light of one of Silky's crux conjurations. Their bickering only occasionally cuts through the crackling fire and the mountainous Hra's grumbling meditation.

Silky whistles a tune as he fries some herbs and miscellaneous dried entoman he brought from home. Despite his cockiness, the fundamentalist was a fantastic cook. So why does the smell make you all feel so bad?

You know why, Rovers. You're blossoming. Becoming one of us. You crave real sustenance, hot wet meat off of the bone - and then the bone too. Crunching, chew-

"Tempted to try?" Silky asks. The rumble-gut of nausea answers the *zusag* for you.

"Perhaps some new items could take your fancy, Rovers," Mo beckons.

Mo holds out a number of foul looking items - **What did they do to us?** - organs spliced and drained into flasks, blades of hooked xulc teeth and grafted bone, sacs of gas and meat and bone. "We have more ideas in the works, but so far, it appears we can use the xulc's extreme bioplasticity against them." **You'll be first, crafter.**

You must admit, there is a degree of comfort offered by knowing these things can be dismantled and used.

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You feel some primitive sense of control, like the first theran to show dominance over its environ through the use of tools. You'll take what victories you can get.

Victory!



Mo and Makaal can make use of the material you retrieved from the Keb Rasska xulc colony. Add the Xulc merchant deck to the store.

Rovers gain 25*R .

On your Xulc campaign log mark the milestone **"Acquired the Samples"**.

Campaign Link



Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone **"Opened Your Third Eye"** or **"Hra The Mountain"** marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 7 - **"Half in Another World"**,  38 or
Encounter 8 - **"Thief of Light, Giver of Light"**,
 46.

If you have the milestones **"Hra The Mountain"** marked and **"Opened Your Third Eye"** not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 7 - **"Half in Another World"**,  42.

If you have the milestones **"Opened Your Third Eye"** marked and **"Hra The Mountain"** not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 8 - **"Thief of Light, Giver of Light"**,  48.

Recycled Parts

Conclusion

Packing the last of the living xulc samples into the basket on Grandpaw's back, the arkenyn growls in protest. "It's okay big fella" says Makaal as he runs his fingers through Grandpaw's fur. "They won't hurt you." You aren't entirely sure who Makaal is referring to.

Later, at camp, Mo and Makaal are tinkering by the light of Hra's innate fulgurations. The starling is swelling in power by the day, as if the crux within them is reaching a kind of critical level. You wonder who will break first - you or the starling, and what would happen when either of you do.



Silky whistles a tune as he fries some herbs and misc dried entoman he brought from home. Despite his cockiness, the fundamentalist was a fantastic cook. So why did the smell make you all feel so nauseous?

You know why, Rovers. You're blossoming. Becoming one of us. You crave real sustenance, hot wet meat off of the bone - and then the bone too. Crunching, chew-

"Tempted to try?" Silky asks. NO. You didn't mean to shout that aloud. But you did.

Silence hangs, save for the crackling of the food in the pan. They fear you as much as they feel sorry for you. **Let them.**

"Perhaps some new items could help... ease your temperaments, Rovers," Mo beckons.

Mo holds out a number of foul looking items - **What did they do to us?** - organs spliced and drained into flasks, blades of hooked xulc teeth and grafted bone, sacs of gas and meat and bone. "We have more ideas in the works, but so far, it appears we can use the xulc's extreme bioplasticity against them." **You'll be first, crafter.**

You must admit, there is a degree of comfort offered by knowing these things can be dismantled and used. As you feel them surging through your system - **we are your system now** - you feel some primitive sense of control, like the first theran to show dominance over its environ through the use of tools. You'll take what victories you can get. The surface of the sand shimmers as Hra stands.

"We move tomorrow." they command. "It's time."

Victory!



Mo and Makaal can make use of the material you retrieved from the Keb Rasska xulc colony. Add the Xulc merchant deck to the store.

Rovers gain 25*R .

On your Xulc campaign log mark the milestone **"Acquired the Samples"**.

Campaign Link



Encounter 9 - **"Promethean Purpose"**,  50.

Conclusion

The infected silvan assault would be enough to deal with, but with the additional lethality of xulc-possessed tihfur, the site of the ritual is a riot of flying arrows and rending talons. Pressure builds from the Morphic ritual as it reaches a zenith, until it peaks. A cacophony of sensation erupts from the centre of the mystics.

What?

A wave of energy rushes over you, and for a moment the world is unfathomably overstimulating. Smoke emanates from the mystics, who fall to their knees in exhaustion. Infected tihfur both in containment and on the battleground around you let out a scream. Smoke begins to emanate from them too as they leak bubbling grey onto the ground. **How?** Twisted talons and bulging mutations undo themselves, fall to the ground as weakened xulc parasites, which are immediately executed by the Yanshif. Around you, tihfur are cured. **This can't** be. Silky runs from his hideout to your side.

"It worked," Mo, Makaal and Hra each let out a tremendous cheer, joined by the hoot-like hollers of the Yanshif and the rumbling roars of the Urshif! No.

Silky continues through the cheer, "if the Yanshif mystics were able to do this for their own, they can teach us the principles. Though they did so with their unbound access to Morph. If we find a way to generate enough etheric energy that matches the ether in each of you, we can replicate it. And we can pass on that replication process to others across Lalos."

No. **We won't let you go.** The xulc parasite speaks to your minds as one, at once. It hurts. **You are too important to us. We won't let you leave. We gave you vitality. We can take it away.** You buckle to the immense pain across your bodies. You can feel the xulc parasite asserting its dominance over you. Throughout you. Silky rushes to your sides. "And I suppose we'd better find a way to replicate it fast."



Victory!



The ritual was a success. The xulc parasites were expelled from those of the **Urshif** that were resisting the infection. The parasite within you is scared and asserting its dominance.

All Rovers must make a choice. They must either reduce their maximum ♥ by 3, returning your base ♥ to the same value on your class board, or select and permanently add one infected skill card to their hand. This infected card **DOES** count toward the number of skill or reaction cards you may take in an encounter.

Rovers gain 25*R

On your Xulc campaign sheet mark the milestone "**Completed the Ritual**".

Campaign Link



Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone "**Acquired the Samples**" or "**Hra The Mountain**" marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 6 - "**Mapping Oblivion**", 32 or
Encounter 8 - "**Thief of Light, Giver of Light**", 46.

If you have the milestones "**Hra The Mountain**" marked and "**Acquired the Samples**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 6 - "**Mapping Oblivion**", 36.

If you have the milestones "**Acquired the Samples**" marked and "**Hra The Mountain**" not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 8 - "**Thief of Light, Giver of Light**", 48.

No Sky Could Blind You Now

Conclusion

The infected silvan assault would be enough to deal with, but with the additional lethality of xulc-possessed tihfur and the monstrous assault of grafted terranape, the site of the ritual is a riot of flying arrows and rending talons. Pressure builds from the Morphic ritual as it



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reaches a zenith, until it peaks. A cacophony of sensation erupts from the centre of the mystics.

What?

A wave of energy rushes over you, and for a moment the world is unfathomably overstimulating. Smoke emanates from the mystics, who fall to their knees in exhaustion. Infected tihfur both in containment and on the battleground around you let out a scream. Smoke begins to emanate from them too as they leak bubbling grey onto the ground. **How?** Twisted talons and bulging mutations undo themselves, fall to the ground as weakened xulc parasites, which are immediately executed by the Yanshif. Around you, tihfur are cured. **This can't be.** Silky runs from his hideout to your side.

"It worked." Mo, Makaal and Hra each let out a tremendous cheer, joined by the hoot-like hollers of the remaining Yanshif and the rumbling roars of the wounded Urshif! No.

Silky continues through the cheer, "if the Yanshif mystics were able to do this for their own, they can teach us the principles. Though they did so with their unbound access to Morph. If we find a way to generate enough etheric energy that matches the ether in each of you, we can replicate it. And we can pass on that replication process to others across Lalos."

No. **We won't let you go.** The xulc parasite speaks to your minds as one, at once. It hurts. **You are too important to us. We won't let you leave. We gave you vitality. We can take it away.** You buckle to the immense pain across your bodies. You can feel the xulc parasite asserting its dominance over you. Throughout you. Silky rushes to your side, but it is the thundering voice of the ether-charged Hra that you hear first. "Worry not."

Amidst the jubilation and exhaustion, their voice is illumination itself, it speaks with knowledge of something you don't have.

"Rest now. Resist the xulc. We move tomorrow," they command.

"It's time."

Victory!



The ritual was a success. The xulc parasites were expelled from those of the **Urshif** that were resisting the infection. The parasite within you is scared

and asserting its dominance.

All Rovers must make a choice. They must either reduce their maximum ♥ by 3, returning your base ♥ to the same value on your class board, or select and permanently add one infected skill card to their hand. This infected card **DOES** count toward the number of skill or reaction cards you may take in an encounter.

Rovers gain 25*R ♦.

On your Xulc campaign sheet mark the milestone "**Completed the Ritual**".

Campaign Link



Encounter 9 - "**Promethean Purpose**", 50.

You're Glowing

Conclusion

With the last crackling strike from above, Hra detonates. Between the crevices of their stone and vine body the constant sparking of lightning erupts out, licks of pure crux charge strike the bodies of the xulc-infected. It all happens in a flash. Burned out corpses fall to the ground, hair and fur stands on end, and a pang of dizziness overwhelms you as the resonant charge temporarily disrupts your nervous systems. Your xulc parasite voice just whines in exhaustion. Where Hra was is now a huge plume of impenetrable smoke.

"Hra?" Silky, now nearly a perfect sphere of charged, puffy fur, throws his question into the smoke. The zusag grabs his Aeiro by the feet and is flown over into the smouldering plume. He conjures some glyph magic, clearing the smoke instantly, and there you see them.

Hra, resplendent, luminous, even bigger. The stone in their form appears almost glass-like, the plant-life a more vibrant, neon shade of green. **Foul beast.**

Thus far avoiding the lightning, Mo edges closer to the newly ether-charged Hra. "How... do you feel, Hra?"

"Ready," Hra answers with a crackling boom.

"Ready for what, my luminous luminary?" Silky asks, patting his fur down.

"What comes next," answers Hra.

Victory!



Rovers gain 25*R

For the remainder of the campaign, during encounters use Hra's **"Ether-charged" side**.

On your Xulc campaign log mark the milestone **"Hra The Mountain"**.

Campaign Link



Check your campaign sheet, if you do not have either milestone **"Acquired the Samples"** or **"Completed the Ritual"** marked, select your next encounter:

Encounter 6 - **"Mapping Oblivion"**, 32 or
Encounter 7 - **"Half in Another World"**, 38.

If you have the milestones **"Completed the Ritual"** marked and **"Acquired the Samples"** not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 6 - **"Mapping Oblivion"**, 36.

If you have the milestones **"Acquired the Samples"** marked and **"Completed the Ritual"** not marked, proceed to:

Encounter 7 - **"Half in Another World"**, 42.

Apocalypse Conduit

Conclusion

With the last crackling strike from above, Hra detonates. Between the crevices of their stone and vine body the constant sparking of lightning erupts out, licks of pure crux charge strike the bodies of the xulc-infected. It all happens in a flash. Burned out corpses fall to the ground, hair and fur stands on end, and a pang of dizziness overwhelms you as the resonant charge temporarily disrupts your nervous systems. Where Hra was is now a huge plume of impenetrable smoke.

A vile thing! A terrible thing! The xulc speaks aloud through you again. Bile rises in your throat as your increasingly mutated form shudders in the presence of such ether, and at least one of you falls to the ground in the agony of the atmosphere.

Silky has no clue whom to attend to first - the



smoke cloud that was Hra, or the clear pain you're all in. Hra answers for you. In a secondary discharge of lightning, the smoke burns away.

Hra, resplendent, luminous, even bigger. **What a horrid monster.** The stone in their form appears almost glass-like, the plant-life a more vibrant, neon shade of green. **Kill it. Kill it now.**

Thus far avoiding the lightning, Mo edges closer to the newly ether-charged Hra, being sure to move around your agonized forms, though the pain begins to shift.

"How... do you feel, Hra?"

The water ether in Mo's body gently bubbles in the presence of the lightning, adding a subtle vibrato to their question.

"Ready," Hra answers with a crackling boom. Hra moves towards you - **KILL IT STOP IT N** - and a sharp pain takes over. The xulc voice rages, but then is muffled, suppressed by Hra's immediate proximity. With that, the pain subsides. A moment of genuine, though temporary, relief.

"Ready for what, my luminous luminary?" Silky asks, patting his fur down.

"What comes next," answers Hra.

Victory!



Rovers gain 25*R

For the remainder of the campaign, during encounters use Hra's **"Ether-charged" side**.

On your Xulc campaign log mark the milestone **"Hra The Mountain"**.

Campaign Link



Encounter 9 - **"Promethean Purpose"**, 50.

It's Not Over

Q 25

The Hastadilling is strong, even in your mind. But you've done this before. You do your foul surgery once again, and dismantle the corrupted monstrosity.

You think me but one thing Rovers? After all we've done! I am everything! I am the water in the well, I am the dark of the shadow - it is all mine for it is all me!

The psychogeography rends asunder - a shadow twists and wrenches itself out from the shadow of a stone into a giant simulacrum of a Crown, the grass grows a bloated, viscous body of muscle akin to a Terranape, the sky congeals into armored body of a mutated Gruv. All of your mind's world attacks.

Special Rules



The Parasite Changes

Spawn one Fracturing Gruv where the Hastadilling was, one Bursting Terranape adjacent to the closest Rover, and one Fading Crown within ↗ 4 of where the Hastadilling was, furthest away from the most Rovers.

Codex Links



Q 26

At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, read "It's Gone?",  15.

It's Gone?

Q26

Conclusion

PAIN. You disembowel the shadows.

STOP. You burn all the grass from the world.

Please

You pull the sky down from its mantle by the throat and crush its skull.

This twisted place, what the xulc parasite had done to your mind and your soul, it's influence and corruption and hatred and fear. It all bleeds out unceremoniously, a dying animal in a ditch. Silent at last.

Light pierces through. Hra's Light. All around, across the violet sky, vast constellations appear in concentric triads, the sign of the teacher, the sign of the artisan, the sign of the young prince.



Q 26

You feel the pulsing of the tihfur ritual, that same kaleidoscopic barrage, but this time all across your being. Muscles unwrap, bones vibrate, saliva and blood effervesce. Color and sound and pulling, a yawning pulling in your guts, a widening out, inversion so comprehensive you fear your organs will spill across the floor, a stretching so far beyond that you are certain your skin will shred and your bones will shatter. Everyone looks like everyone else, looks like you, flowers like oceans like stars like beasts in the sky above, heaven twisting into itself, falling across itself like rain, like blood, like meteors, like all of the things you've ever seen or held or wept over laid over each other, glittering, wrapped all around you like silk.

Before your soul breaks under the weight, normality reasserts itself as the ritual completes. The bridal veil of your communion with everything that ever was is let back down by the feeble limits of your mind, and reality quietly re-dresses itself in the prudish gaze of mortal consciousness.

Hra's walls are here again. Their floor, their ceiling. Your minds are yours again, the mutations gone, your bodies hale and strong. Like none of this ever happened

On the ground, a handful of xulc parasites wriggle out of Hra's altar. They seem so weak, those things that stole you. So pathetic. They collapse over each other as they scramble, over and over. They don't part now, acting as some gelatinous rolling ball. You look at each other, wondering when to intervene. The answer to that question comes, and it is 'a moment ago', as the xulc bundle grafts itself and shifts into a new form. A similar form to that of a human or tihfur. It has arms, a head, and it can talk.

"Thhhhank you... Rovers. You gave us.. Me, all I needed after all."

With quicksilver speed, the xulc being disappears out of Hra's hall.

Victory!



Your infection has been expelled!

All infected cards are removed from your hand, your hand size is reduced by 1, your infected trait reverts to the class trait it replaced (refer to the note you made in the campaign sheet), and your maximum  is set to what is noted on your class board.



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Remove Hra's ally card from the game.

Rovers gain 40*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 10 - "Collapse, Greying & Disintegration",  52.

Everything Executioner



You ruin the clusters around the prime xulc's hive, and it can no longer clot any wound you deal it faster than you can deal another. Something like a scream emanates out from the gelatinous chrysalis, a stream of bubbles rising as your next blow pierces the giant cell-wall and the embryonic fluid drains onto the beach.

Untangling itself like a swarm of snakes, the prime xulc leaps out between you all. It rises high, - it's grown since you saw it last, looking increasingly humanoid.

"**Why won't you let us live!**" It roars with a throat full of bile.

Silky answers from a zusagart, conjured glyphs scattering the sound around like a multi-tonal chorus of woodblocks, "because, new thing, such a privilege requires mutuality. Permission to survive was not a kindness your kind granted to the rest of us."

"New thing... **you** have little clue, zusag," the xulc spits. Its body continues to uncurl.

"**Though I suppose in a sense you're correct. An aspect of us is new. Consciousness... intelligence - rushed into us in a matter of hours. Base impulse, only the water and the dark... to everything else in sheer moments. The knowledge that there was more to experience, if we found a...host that we could convince to allow us to. But now, what you have given, the power of you Rovers, is far more than we could have wanted, in all our days of living.**"

The xulc undulates and reforms, moving its serpentine form into the shapes and forms of the many mutations that once plagued your bodies. "**We carry you all within us now. Your powers, your strength, your minds... Thank you, Rovers. It has been a gift. I'm sorry things must end this way.**"



Special Rules



Phase 2

Proceed to  28 and  18.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to defeat the Prime Xulc Dominator.

Prime Xulc Dominator



The Prime Xulc attacks relentlessly.

The Prime Xulc takes R turns each round. Roll the adversary ability dice before each turn to determine which ability they perform.

They have two rows of 4 abilities, for a total of 8 abilities. These still act like one track. When the ability token advances beyond the 4th ability, place the token on the 5th ability and continue advancing the token along the track. When the token would advance beyond ability 8, it wraps around back to ability 1.

Codex Links



At the end of the round where the Xulc Prime Dominator has been defeated, read "**If It Bleeds, We Can Kill It**",  16.

If It Bleeds, We Can Kill It



The xulc throws everything it has at you, even that which once was you. It's strong, but you're stronger. They mirror your movements, match your strikes with blocks, they know you. They studied you. But they can't be all of you at once. They begin to slow, even by a fraction of a second, and that's all you need to exploit the opening. You're Rovers after all, heroes of your people, and rarely has a being been such a notable threat to all of your people at once.

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Black blood sprays as you cut and tear. Another shriek rings out. A familiar shriek, one of fear, of desperation. The xulc retreats into the ocean faster than you can catch it.

“Remember, Rovers. The water and the dark was our home before your ancestors could talk.” The xulc raises themselves out of the water with a lithe, masterful grace that makes their quicksilver movements on land look sluggish in comparison. Their blood still trickles into the water. You know what that means.

Special Rules

Phase 3

The Xulc Prime is on the back foot and has retreated to the ocean. Stop them once and for all before they escape!

Proceed to  29 and  19.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to defeat the Prime Xulc Deliverer.

Prime Xulc Deliverer

The Prime Xulc is the master of their domain.

There are 6 ether icons along the edge of the map, two icons per space.

At the beginning of each of the Prime Xulc's turns they will dive and emerge at random locations along the coast. Roll an ether dice from the general pool and place the Prime Xulc's primary hex in the space that corresponds with the result of the roll, with all of their other hexes occupying a water space.

Codex Links

 29

At the end of the round where the Prime Xulc Deliverer has been slain, read “Victory!”,  17.

Conclusion

The xulc dies. No final speech, no further plea for mercy. They try to kill you, they nearly succeed, but you kill them first. Their body sinks into the water for a moment, then rises to the surface face down. It's done. The waves rise and crash. A pair of scavenger birds circle overhead.

Over the horizon you can see hundreds of tiny impacts. The xulc are retreating into the ocean in all forms. All over the western coast.

You stay here until the sun begins to fall. Hacking away at the remaining xulc biostructures from the prime xulc, catching and killing those parasites that pass by you on their mass exodus. What caused them to flee? Will they return?

You know these are questions that need to be answered, but not right now. Right now, you are cleaners, surrogate custodians of the coastline, purging the living remains of the prime xulc.

In the weeks after, you're retiring in Tuor once again, as you were before the xulc invasion. Mo and Makaal are with you this time. Makaal wears a sliver of Hra's crystal shrine in an amulet around his neck and appears to have a newfound interest in spirituality and rituals. Mo is working on a couple of reports for the Fundamentalists of the Eye School and the Yanshif mystics on their xulc-craft, given the sheer amount of excess biomass the parasites left behind.

Grandpaw has a newfound anxiety about the ocean, but everyone is working on that.

Silky has been receiving reports from across the various clans and communities. They're all much the same - the xulc left one day, many of them leaving behind their hosts in mostly survivable conditions. Many were lost, some entire clans even.

Lalos grieves for what was. But there is also the possibility of something new.

In a week's time, Silky will hold a conference in New Era for the leaders of many clans across Lalos to discuss the xulc invasion, as well as begin the development of formal mutual aid networks. Representatives from various tihfur, starling, human, and Keb Rasska clans, as well as many zusag school Fundamentalists will all be in attendance.

Silky also mentioned some clans and people you have never heard of. This conference will be proof that a future is to be had, if the people of the world can be brave enough to salvage it together.

Deep beneath the water, the salvaging has already begun.

Victory!



Congratulations

You have won! The campaign is now over.



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